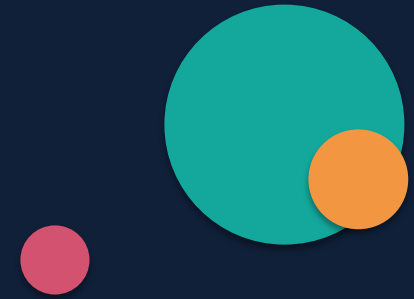


The Global Burden

of Mental Illness



Prevalence, Impact, and the Treatment Gap

Global mental health data, 2023

Source: Our World in Data — Mental Health; IHME Global Burden of Disease (2025)

For public health policy analysts and mental health program planners

Hundreds of Millions Affected: 1 in 3 Women and 1 in 5 Men Face Major Depression

Major depression over the lifetime

1 in 3

women

will experience major depression



1 in 5

men

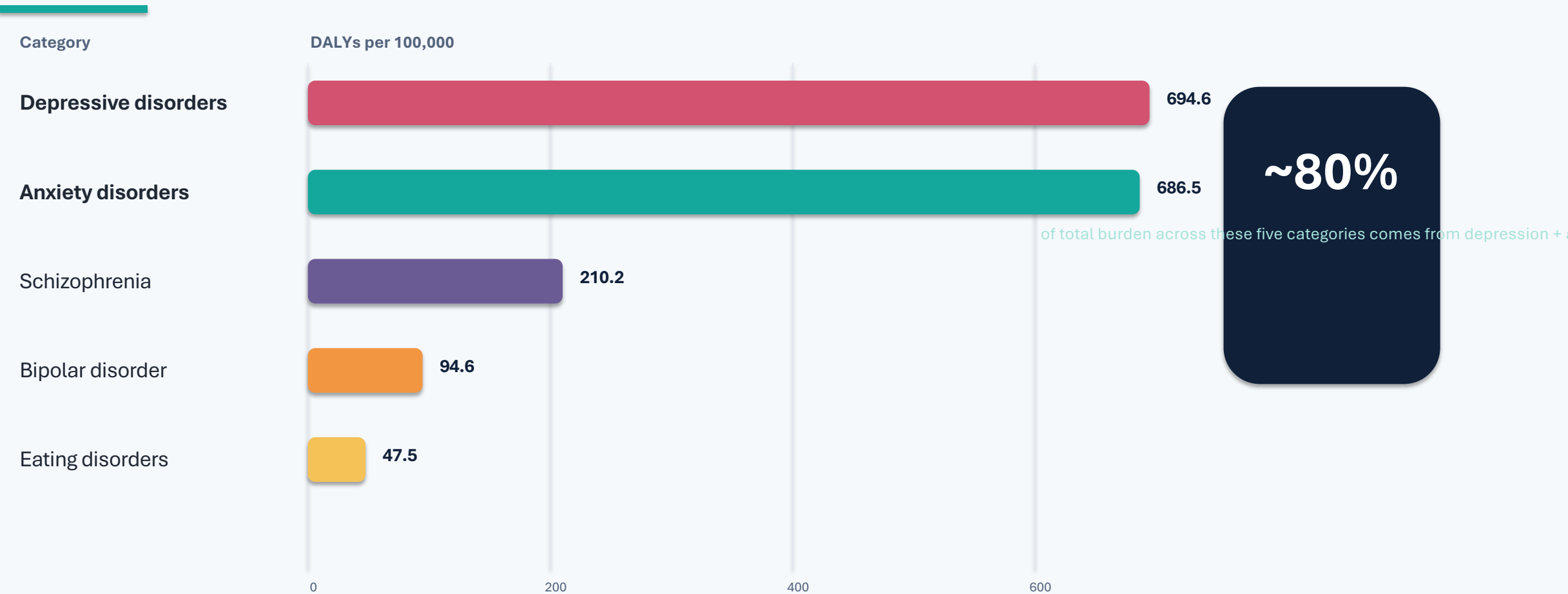
will experience major depression



Why it matters for policy

- Poor mental health affects well-being, work, and re
- Conditions range from common depression and an
- Many more people experience mental health cond

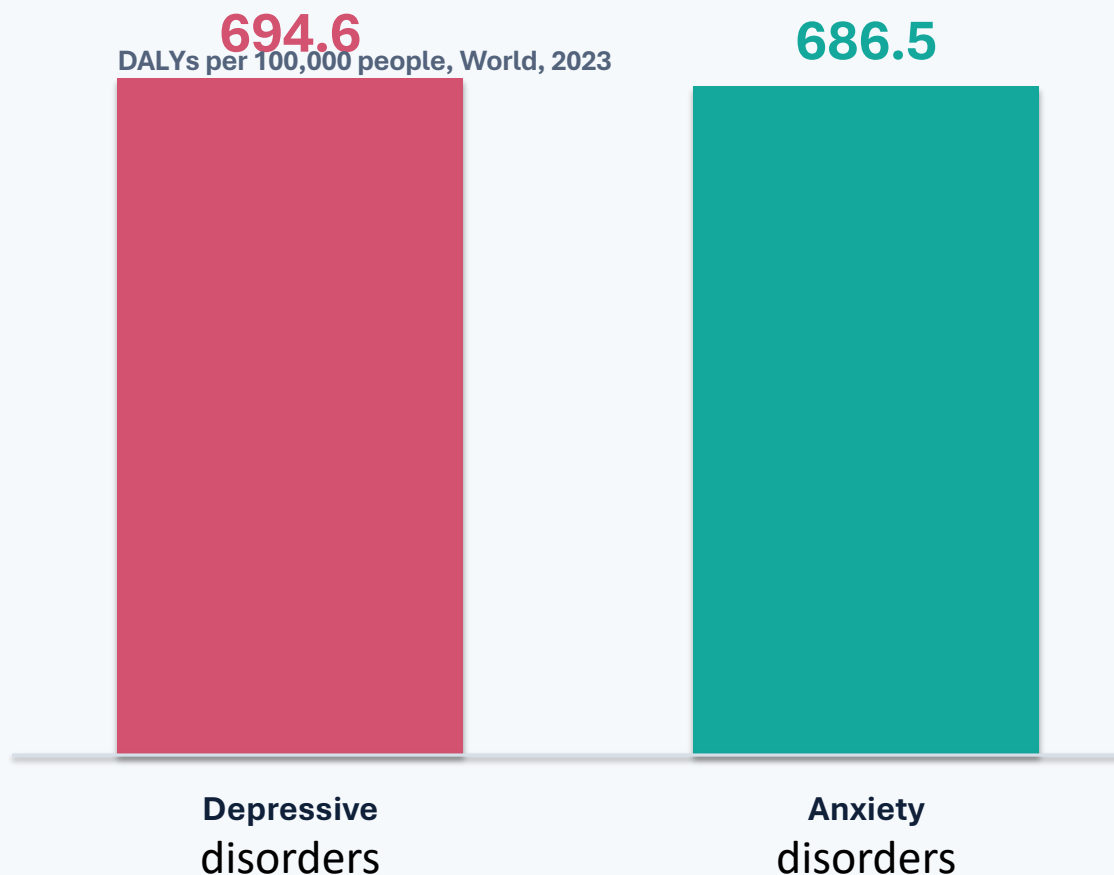
Depression and Anxiety Dominate: ~695 and ~687 DALYs per 100K Respectively



DALYs combine years of life lost due to premature death and years lived with disability.

Reference: figure_1

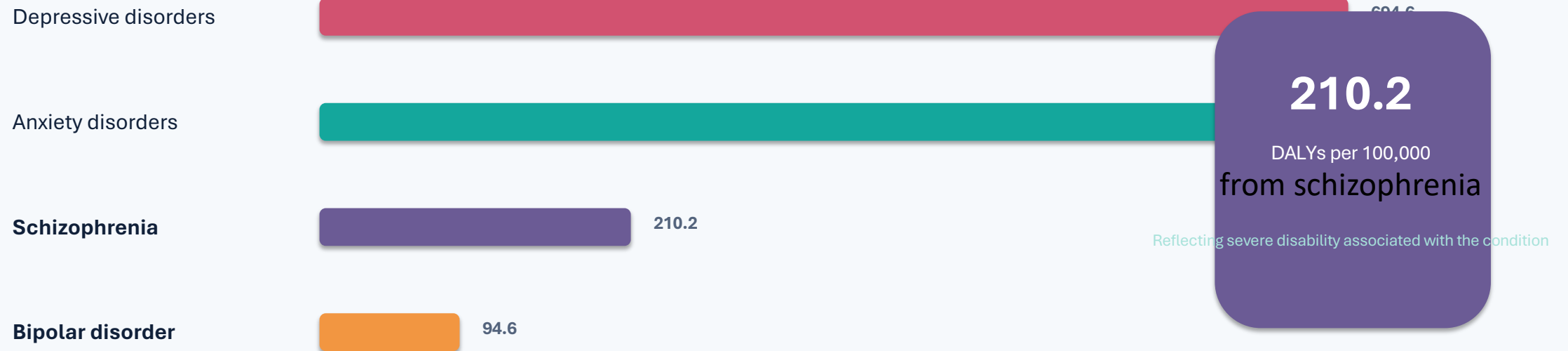
Depression and Anxiety Carry Nearly Equal Disease Burden Worldwide



Core signal

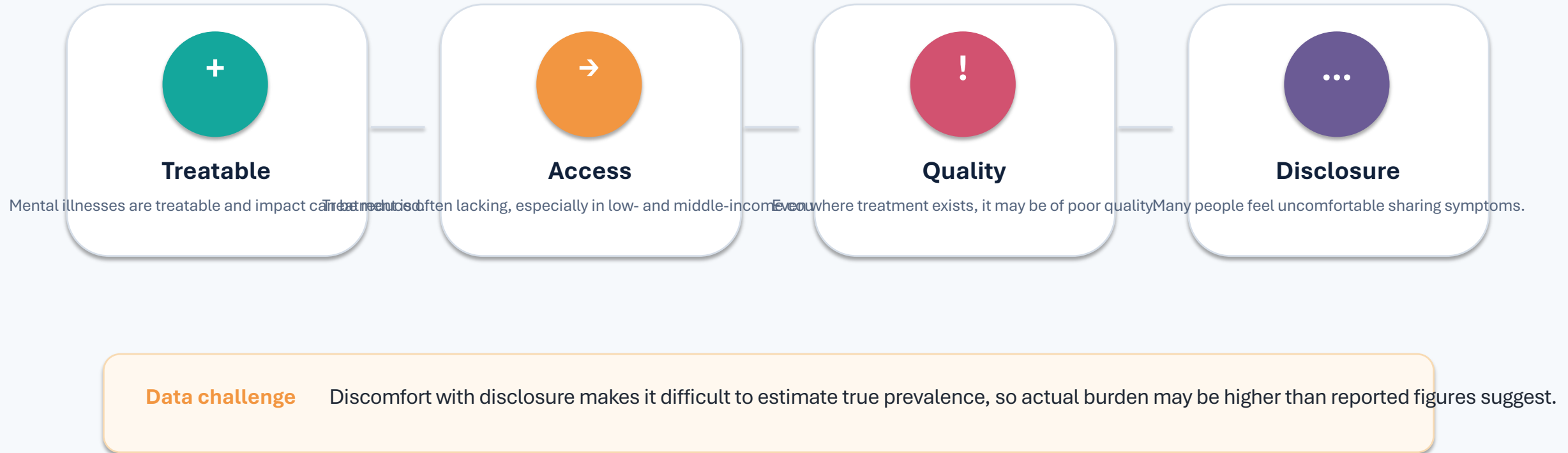
- Rates are nearly identical: about 695 vs 687 DALYs p
- Together, they dominate the global mental health bu
- Their population-level burden dwarfs other listed cat

Schizophrenia and Bipolar Disorder: Lower Prevalence but Severe Individual Impact



Policy interpretation: population-level burden is lower for schizophrenia and bipolar disorder, while the brief emphasizes severe disability and large impacts on individuals

Treatment Is Available but Often Lacking or Poor Quality



How People Cope: From Medication to Faith to Family Conversations



Prescribed medication

Common in higher-income settings



Religious or spiritual activities

Prevalent in many regions worldwide



Talking to friends or family

A widely reported coping mechanism

Implication: responses vary widely across countries and are shaped by cultural, economic, and healthcare system factors — policy should avoid one-size-fits-all

Reference: figure_2

Key Takeaways: Prioritizing Depression, Anxiety, and Closing the Treatment Gap

1

Prioritize common disorders: Depression and anxiety together represent the overwhelming majority of mental health DALYs across the five L

2

Maintain specialized care: Schizophrenia and bipolar disorder carry disproportionate individual burden despite lower population-level burde

3

Close the treatment gap: Treatment exists, but access and quality remain inadequate.

4

Reduce stigma: Stigma suppresses both help-seeking and accurate data through underreporting.

5

Fit interventions to context: Coping strategies vary widely across countries and cultures.

Action orientation: scale evidence-based interventions for depression and anxiety while preserving specialized pathways for severe conditions.